INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-17/187C
w/AMENDMENT 1
09 May 2019
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-17/187C
22 May 2014

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

CABLE, RADIO FREQUENCY, FLEXIBLE COAXIAL, 50 OHMS, M17/187-00001

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-DTL-17.

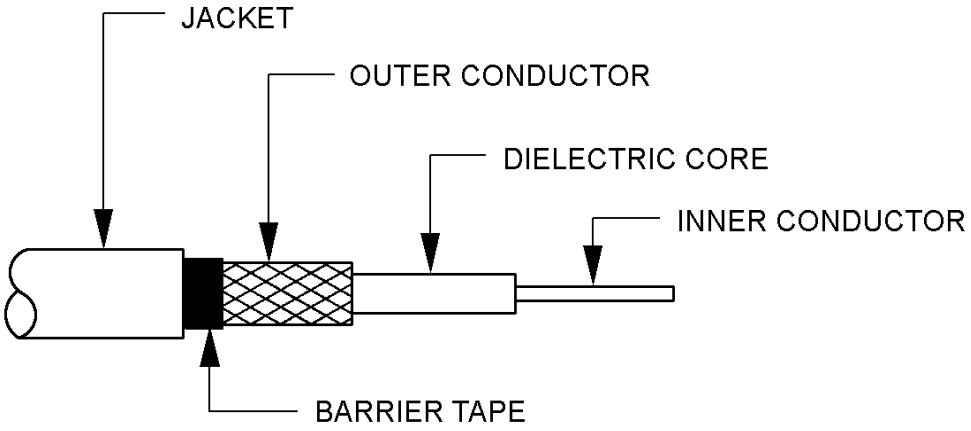


FIGURE 1. Configuration.

TABLE I. Description.

Components	Construction details
Inner conductor	Twenty-seven strands of tinned copper wire, each strand .005 inch diameter. Overall diameter: .0308 inch ± .0020.
Dielectric core	Type A-1: Solid polyethylene. Diameter: .096 inch ± .003.
Outer conductor	Single braid of AWG No. 36, tinned copper wire. Diameter: .126 inch maximum. Alternate Coverage: 95.3% nominal 99.3% nominal Carriers: 16 24 Ends: 6 5 Picks/inch: 12.9 ± 10% 12.2 ± 10%
Barrier tape	A .001 inch thick polyester tape faced with a .002 inch thick layer of aluminum. The tape will be applied with a 50% lap, aluminum face toward the outer conductor. Diameter: .136 inch maximum.
Jacket	Cross-linked polyolefin. Diameter: .160 inch ± .005. Jacket thickness: .012 inch minimum.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

ENGINEERING INFORMATION

Continuous working voltage: 1,400 V rms, maximum.

Operating frequency: 1 GHz, maximum.

Velocity of propagation: 65.9 percent, nominal.

Power ratings: See figure 2.

Operating temperature range: -30°C to +85°C.

Inner conductor properties:

DC resistance (maximum at +20°C): 1.79 ohms per 100 feet.

Elongation: 10 percent, minimum.

Engineering notes: This cable is useful in general purpose, medium low temperature applications. (See connector series “TNC”, “BNC” and “SMA” in accordance with MIL-PRF-39012.) These cables were redesigned to meet the vertical flame test.

REQUIREMENTS:

Dimensions, configuration, and descriptions: See figure 1 and table I.

Environmental and mechanical:

Visual and mechanical examination: Applicable.

Diameter: Applicable.

Out-of-roundness: Not applicable.

Eccentricity: 10 percent maximum.

Adhesion of conductors: Inner conductor to core: 1.3 pounds, minimum; 13 pounds, maximum.

Electrical and mechanical:

Continuity: Applicable.

Spark test: 3,000 V rms, minimum.

Voltage withstanding: 5,000 V rms, minimum.

Insulation resistance: Not applicable.

Corona extinction voltage: 1,900 V rms, minimum.

Characteristic impedance: 50 ± 2 ohms.

RF transmission loss (attenuation): See figure 2.

Standing wave ratio (return loss): See figure 3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Capacitance: 32.2 pF per foot, maximum.

Capacitance stability: Not applicable.

Capacitance unbalance: Not applicable.

Transmission unbalance: Not applicable.

Inductance: Not applicable.

Mechanically induced noise: Not applicable.

Time delay: Not applicable.

Aging stability: +98°C ± 2°C.

Stress crack resistance: Not applicable.

Outer conductor integrity: Not applicable.

Cold bend: -30°C ± 2°C.

Dimensional stability: +85°C ± 2°C.

Inner conductor from core: .062 inch, maximum.

Inner conductor from jacket: .125 inch, maximum.

Contamination: Not applicable.

Bendability: Not applicable

Flammability: Not applicable

Flame propagation: Applicable.

Acid gas generation: 2.0 percent, maximum.

Halogen content: 0.2 percent, maximum.

Immersion test:

Tensile strength, percent of unaged minimum: 50

Elongation, percent of unaged minimum: 50.

Smoke index: 25 maximum.

Toxicity index: 5 maximum.

Durometer hardness: (Type A) 80 minimum.

Weathering: Applicable.

Abrasion resistance: 75 cycles minimum (jacket only).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tear strength: 35 pounds per inch minimum.

Heat distortion: 30 percent maximum distortion.

Physical tests on unaged jacket:

Tensile strength: 1,300 psi, minimum.

Elongation, 160 percent, minimum.

Physical tests on aged jacket:

Air oven:

Tensile strength, percent minimum: 60

Elongation, percent minimum: 60

Hot oil immersion:

Tensile strength, percent minimum: 50

Elongation, percent minimum: 50

Tensile strength and elongation: 1,300 psi, 160 percent minimum.

Weight: 2.3 pounds per 100 feet maximum.

Workmanship: Applicable.

Part or Identifying Number (PIN): M17/187-00001.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

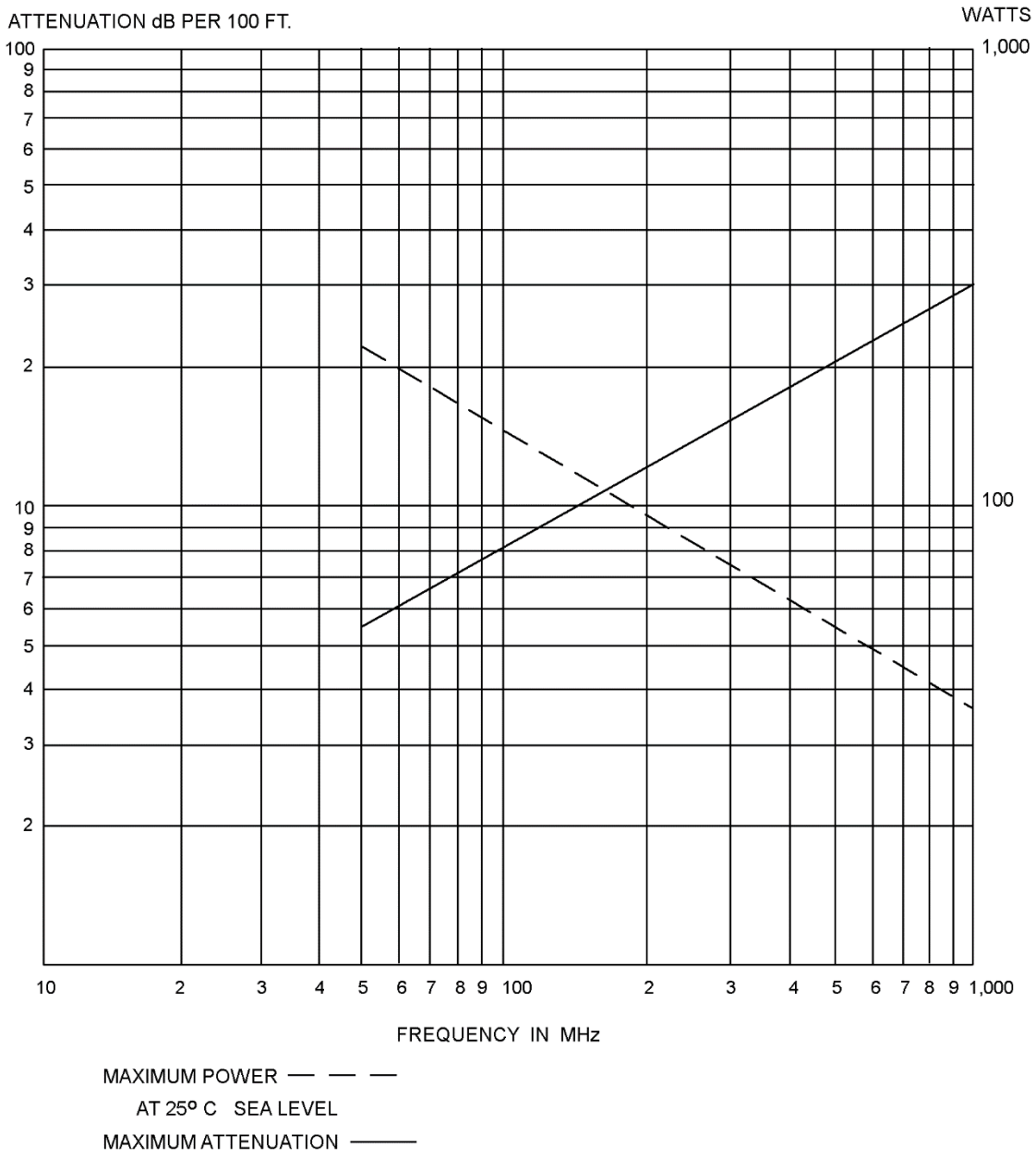


FIGURE 2. Power rating and attenuation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

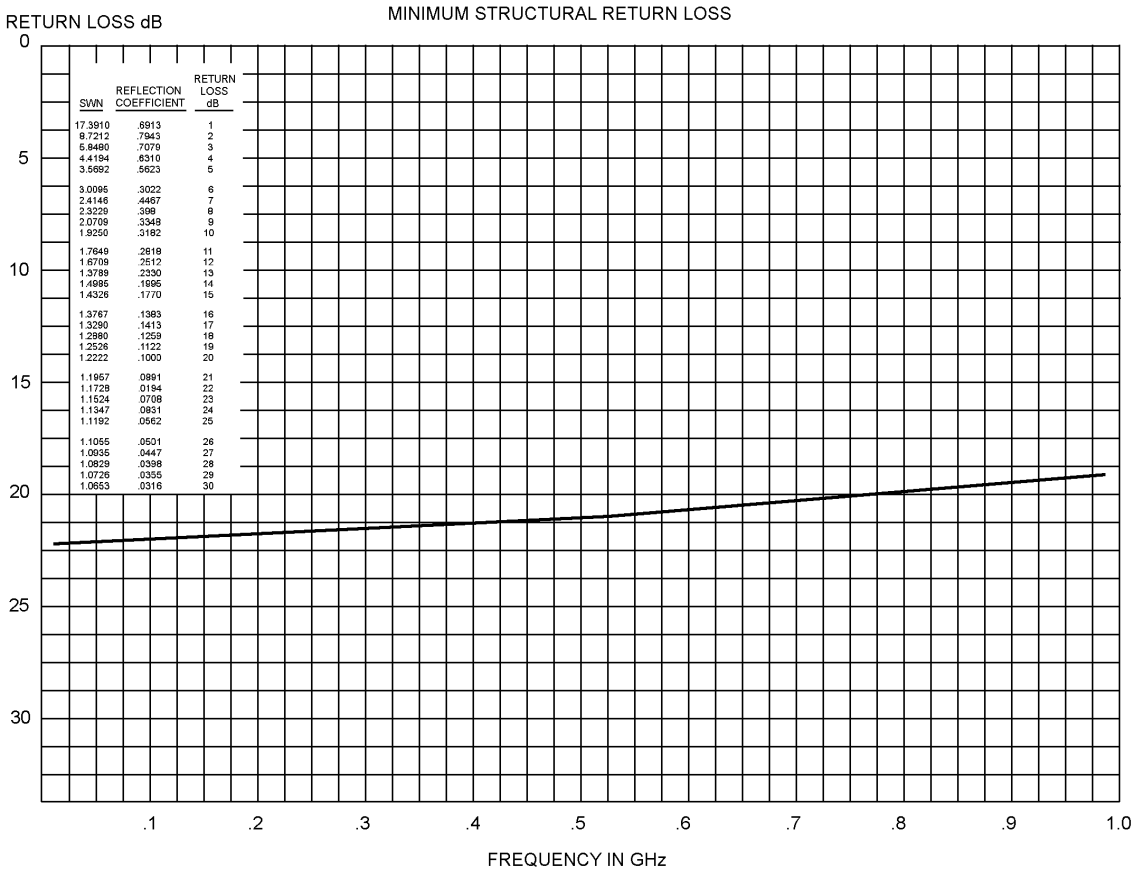


FIGURE 3. Structural return loss.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and Group A, B, and C Table.

Group	Qualification inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Qual- # of Specimens	Conf - # of Specimens	Conformance inspection
I	In-process inspection:		4.5	Entire sample		
	Continuity	3.7.1	4.8.2	Entire sample		
	Spark test	3.7.2	4.8.3	Entire sample		
	Voltage withstanding	3.7.3	4.8.4	Entire sample		
	Insulation resistance	N/A				
	Visual and mechanical inspection	3.6	4.8.1	Entire sample	Per Table VIII	A
	Diameter measurements.	3.6.1	4.8.1.1	Entire sample	Per Table VIII	A
	Out-of-roundness	N/A				
	Eccentricity of inner conductor	3.6.3	4.8.1.3	2	Per Table VIII	A
	Adhesion of conductors	3.6.4	4.8.1.4	4	Per Table VIII	A
	Marking	3.8	4.8.1	Entire sample	Per Table VIII	A
	Workmanship	3.10	4.8.1	Entire sample	Per Table VIII	A
II	Corona extinction voltage	3.7.5	4.8.6	1	Per Table VIII	B
	Characteristic impedance	3.7.6	4.8.7	1	Per Table VIII	A
	RF transmission loss (attenuation)	3.7.7	4.8.8	2	Per Table VIII	A
	Standing wave ratio (return loss)	N/A				
	Capacitance	3.7.9	4.8.10	1	Per Table VIII	B
	Capacitance stability	N/A				
	Capacitance unbalance	N/A				
	Transmission unbalance	N/A				
	Inductance	N/A				
	Mechanically induced noise voltage	N/A				

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and Group A, B, and C Table – Continued.

Group	Qualification inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Qual- # of Specimens	Conf - # of Specimens	Conformance inspection
II	Time delay	N/A				
	Aging stability	3.7.15	4.8.16	4	Per Table VIII	C
	Stress crack resistance	N/A				
	Outer conductor integrity	N/A				
	Cold bend	3.7.18	4.8.19	3	Per Table VIII	B
	Dimensional stability	3.7.19	4.8.20	1	Per Table VIII	C
	Contamination	N/A				
	Bendability	N/A				
	Flammability	N/A				
	Flame propagation	3.7.23	4.8.25	1		
	Acid gas generation	3.7.24	4.8.26	1		
	Halogen content	3.7.25	4.8.27	1		
	Immersion tests	3.7.26	4.8.28	1		
	Smoke index	3.7.27	4.8.29	1		
	Toxicity Index	3.7.28	4.8.30	1		
	Durometer hardness	3.7.29	4.8.31	1		
	Weathering	3.7.30	4.8.32	1		
	Abrasion resistance	3.7.31	4.8.33	5		
	Tear strength	3.7.32	4.8.34	6	Per Table VIII	B
	Heat distortion	3.7.33	4.8.35	1	Per Table VIII	C
	Physicals (aged)	3.7.34	4.8.36	1	Per Table VIII	C
	Tensile strength and elongation	3.7.35	4.8.37	1	Per Table VIII	C
	Weight	3.9	4.8.24	1	Per Table VIII	B

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Amendment notations: The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where modifications from this amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

Referenced documents. In addition to MIL-DTL-17, this document references the following:

MIL-PRF-39012

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army – CR
Navy – EC
Air Force – 85
DLA - CC

Preparing activity:
DLA-CC

Review activities:
Army – AR, AT, CR4, MI
Navy – AS, MC, OS, SH
Air Force – 19

(Project: 6145-2019-015)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-15T16:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.